

This is the easiest way of installing software on Linux. Installing from an rpm or deb package might have a problem of unsupported or outdated repositories, or a problem of dependencies. When available, look for a one-click installation, if you are a beginner. If the software you want is not available, look for an alternative that will do the same job.

5.2 Installing from packages (.rpm or .deb)

RPM and DEB are to Linux what executables are to Windows. RPM stands for Red Hat Package Manager, and DEB stands for Debian. Debian is a combination of Debrah and Ian — Ian Murdock being the founder of Debian, and Debrah his girl friend. SuSE and Red Hat were some of the earliest flavours of Linux distributions. Debian also shares the same distinction. Most of the distributions that we see nowadays have their origin from one of these distributions. SuSE itself is derived from Slackware. Mandrake (now Mandriva) and Fedora are both derived from Red Hat. Ubuntu and Knoppix are both derived from Debian, and Linux Mint is derived from Ubuntu. There are some original releases, like dyne:bolic and puppy linux. By and

